

Captain supply: fix completion, then prove airport economics

DECISION MEMO | FOR THE HEAD OF SUPPLY | 30 JUNE 2026 EXTRACT

Run two measured operations pilots—one for onboarding completion and one for airport night supply—before scaling WA002 or airport acquisition.

What I would decide today

Onboarding: of 20,207 January–May signups with a full 30-day follow-up window, 3,532 (17.5%) were approved and 3,485 (17.2%) completed a first order. The Registration Certificate step is the largest volume loss (4,887 captains). A further 2,281 cleared Fitness but had no Insurance upload by day 30.

Airport: between 21:00 and 04:00, only 31.9% of terminal requests were fulfilled. That leaves 46,020 requests unfulfilled over May–June, about 754 per day and 83.6% of the terminal shortage. Daytime fulfilment is 96.0%.

WA002: the simple recipient gap is 17.9 percentage points, but every recipient had already cleared Registration Certificate. After aligning the comparison at that stage and accounting for measured pre-send differences, the observed difference is +4.2 points (95% range +2.7 to +5.8). This is not proof that the message caused the improvement.

Airport trips: suburban trips cancel at 21.0% versus 8.6% in the city core. Only 16.7% of suburban trips receive a return fare within 20 minutes versus 52.8% in the core. This is a directional sample signal; it has no captain ID, completion timestamp, or earnings.

What I would do on Monday

1. Start an Insurance handoff pilot: contact captains 24 hours after a Fitness pass without an Insurance upload, use a comparison group, and target the 2,281-captain pool. The base scenario is about 175 additional approvals per month; image-capture repair is another ~71 scenario approvals per month.
2. Run a 28-night airport pilot: roster 20 slots from 21:00–04:00, test return matching and a bounded fallback, and measure fulfilled requests per available captain-hour. The 10% recovery target is about 75 extra fulfilled requests per night at an expected variable cost of INR 4,560 per night.
3. Hold the growth requests until the pilots prove value. Randomize about 3,856 captains who have cleared the Registration Certificate step for a 4-point WA002 test. Do not fund an airport catchment bonus until the night pilot improves fulfilment and return economics.

Data to fix: 451 document-summary mismatches, 457 clicked-but-undelivered messages, and 380 terminal-hours where the trip sample exceeds hourly request counts.

What I assumed and what would change my answer

The onboarding scenarios assume that 50% of the identified stalled captains can be recovered and that recovered captains perform like comparable historical captains. The airport scenario assumes 80% attendance, 0.75 completed requests per effective captain-hour, INR 30 per available hour, and an INR 60 fallback with a nightly cap. Costs exclude fixed engineering, airport fees, acquisition bonuses, and captain earnings. These are planning inputs; gains can be zero.

I would expand the pilots only if randomized results show incremental approvals or fulfilments, acceptable first-pass quality and complaints, stronger return-fare economics, and Finance-approved unit economics. A null result, poor quality, or no improvement in return utilization would change the recommendation.

The campaign result is an observed, adjusted difference—not a proven causal effect. The airport trip comparison is a sample association, not a marketplace-wide revenue estimate. The hourly airport data do not include flight schedules, queue position, dispatch events, unique captains, completion timestamps, or earnings.

Working files: Part-A_analysis.ipynb, Part-B_analysis.ipynb, app.py, utils.py, and README.md. The notebooks regenerate the tables and charts used by the dashboard and this memo.